

3.1 | IMPAIRED DRIVING

Impaired driving happens when anything makes it hard for you to think straight, respond quickly, or control your car. This includes things like alcohol, drugs, or being tired. All of these can put you, your passengers, and others on the road at risk.

The penalties for impaired driving under the influence of alcohol or drugs are very tough: expensive fines, higher insurance rates, license suspension or withdrawal, and even jail sentences.

Even an experienced driver cannot drive safely after drinking alcohol or using drugs. Making the choice to never drive under the influence will save lives: yours and others'.

ALCOHOL AND DRIVING

Alcohol is the most common impairing substance involved in impaired driving crashes. Be alert for impaired driving behavior of others and give them lots of room.

Alcohol can affect drivers by causing:

- Feelings of relaxation and drowsiness.
- Blurry vision or limited eyesight.
- Reduced reaction times, concentration, and ability to scan the environment.
- Difficulty in understanding what's happening.
- Difficulty doing multiple tasks at once, like staying in a lane and avoiding other traffic.
- Inability to obey the rules of the road.
- Overconfidence, which can lead to risky driving behavior.